

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 18, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 11:10-19

10 Now these were the heads of the mighty men whom David had, who strengthened themselves with him in his kingdom, with all Israel, to make him king, according to the word of the Lord concerning Israel.

11 And this is the number of the mighty men whom David had: Jashobeam the son of a Hachmonite, chief of the captains; he had lifted up his spear against three hundred, killed by him at one time.

12 After him was Eleazar the son of Dodo, the Ahohite, who was one of the three mighty men.

13 He was with David at Pasdammim. Now there the Philistines were gathered for battle, and there was a piece of ground full of barley. So the people fled from the Philistines.

14 But they stationed themselves in the middle of that field, defended it, and killed the Philistines. So the Lord brought about a great victory.

15 Now three of the thirty chief men went down to the rock to David, into the cave of Adullam; and the army of the Philistines encamped in the Valley of Rephaim.

16 David was then in the stronghold, and the garrison of the Philistines was then in Bethlehem.

17 And David said with longing, "Oh, that someone would give me a drink of water from the well of Bethlehem, which is by the gate!"

18 So the three broke through the camp of the Philistines, drew water from the well of Bethlehem that was by the gate, and took it and brought it to David. Nevertheless David would not drink it, but poured it out to the Lord.

19 And he said, "Far be it from me, O my God, that I should do this! Shall I drink the blood of these men who have put their lives in jeopardy? For at the risk of their lives they brought it." Therefore he would not drink it. These things were done by the three mighty men.

II. Key Summary

- The passage opens by listing the heads of David's mighty men, saying they strengthened themselves with him in his kingdom and, together with all Israel, made him king according to the word of the Lord.
 - Two of them are then described: Jashobeam lifted his spear against three hundred at one time, and Eleazar stood in the barley field when everyone else fled and struck down the Philistines — and the text says the Lord brought about a great victory.
 - While David was in the stronghold he said he longed for water from the well of Bethlehem; three men broke through the Philistine camp and brought it back, but David would not drink it and poured it out to the Lord, calling it the blood of these men.
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III. Passage Analysis

What cost someone's life, he would not keep for himself

David was so honored by the self-sacrifice of these three mighty men he felt that the water was too good for him – and worthy to be poured out in sacrifice to the LORD.
[1]

David did not treat that cup of water as a perk he had earned; he knew three lives were inside it. He would rather stay thirsty than take that weight for himself.

The heroes on the list started out with nothing

These men didn't necessarily start as mighty men; many were the distressed, indebted, and discontented people who followed David at Adullam Cave. [2]

The people written into this roll of honor were once a crowd pushed into a cave by their own debts and troubles. Their names lasted because of where they later chose to stand, not because they started out impressive.

IV. Reflection Question

Think of something someone paid a high price to get for you — what did you end up

doing with it?

David would not drink the water his men risked their lives for; he poured it out to God — what costs someone that much, he believed only God could receive.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, "1 Chronicles 11 – David's Reign and Mighty Men", <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-11/>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, "1 Chronicles 11 – David's Reign and Mighty Men", <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-11/>